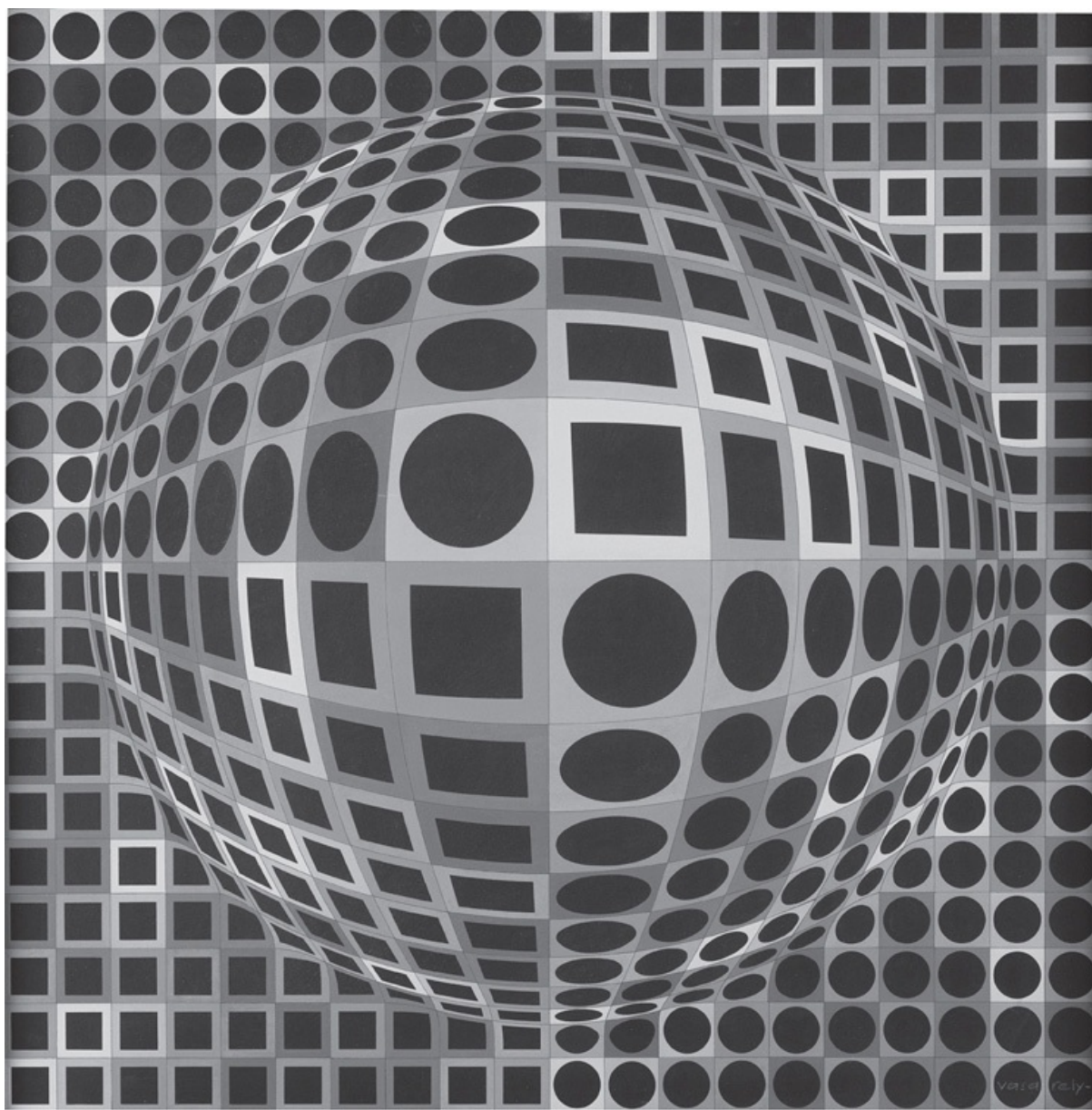


Op art

Beginning in the mid-1950s, Op art saw the possibilities of optical illusion exploited by artists who were inspired by Suprematism, Constructivism, Neo-Plasticism, the Bauhaus and Hard Edge painting. They created abstract, geometric designs and patterns that contrast strongly with their backgrounds in order to generate sensations of movement or vibration in viewers' eyes. Also sometimes called Retinal art, the style was described as Op art (for Optical art) in *Time* magazine in 1964.

Both Op and Kinetic art styles were launched at 'Le Mouvement', a 1955 exhibition in Paris. Ten years later 'The Responsive Eye', another exhibition at the Museum of Modern Art in New York, showed similar work. It included art by Richard Anuszkiewicz (b.1930), Victor Vasarely (1906–97) and Bridget Riley (b.1931), and was enormously popular with the public. Critics denounced it as portraying nothing more than tricks to fool the eye, but Op art caught the collective imagination and led to a craze for similar designs in fashion and the media.



Vasarely, *Vega-Gyongiy-2*, 1971